

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 HOUSE
5 RESOLUTION 1059

By: Munson and Pae

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8 AS INTRODUCED

9 A Resolution honoring May as Asian/Pacific American
10 Heritage Month; recognizing the cultural and economic
11 impact of Asian/Pacific Americans and immigrants; and
12 honoring Oklahomans of Asian/Pacific descent.

13 WHEREAS, May is recognized by the United States Congress as
14 Asian/Pacific American Heritage Month, honoring the contributions
15 and paying tribute to generations of Asian Americans and Pacific
16 Islanders (AAPI) who have made our state and nation their home; and

17 WHEREAS, Asian/Pacific American Heritage Month is celebrated in
18 May to commemorate the immigration of the first Japanese to the
19 United States in May of 1843; and

20 WHEREAS, May also marks the anniversary of the completion of the
21 transcontinental railroad on May 10, 1869. The majority of those
22 who laid the tracks were Chinese immigrants; and
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1 WHEREAS, the Chinese were the first Asian group to settle in
2 Oklahoma, living in the Guthrie Territory after the Land Run of
3 1889; and

4 WHEREAS, the Japanese population quickly grew in Oklahoma in the
5 1920s and 1940s, and during World War II, several fought for the
6 United States, including four sons of Kutaro Nishimuta, a farmer in
7 Payne County. His sons served in the U.S. Army 442nd Regimental
8 Unit, an all-Japanese outfit and one of the most decorated units in
9 the war; and

10 WHEREAS, nearly three percent of all Oklahomans identify as
11 Asian American or Pacific Islander, citing origins in Cambodia,
12 China, India, Japan, Korea, Malaysia, Pakistan, the Philippine
13 Islands, Thailand, Vietnam, Hawaii, Guam, Samoa, or other Pacific
14 Islands; and

15 WHEREAS, Oklahoma City is home to "Little Saigon", the Asian
16 District made up of the state's largest population of Asian
17 descendants, predominately Vietnamese. Visitors flock to the
18 district each year to experience the international cuisine, culture,
19 and shopping; and

20 WHEREAS, Asian American and Pacific Islander citizens have made
21 a tremendous impact on our state and nation, serving in vital roles
22 as state and national leaders, starting businesses, making
23 breakthroughs in science and technology, serving in our military,
24 excelling in sports, arts, education, and more.

1 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
2 OF THE 2ND SESSION OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE:

3 THAT the month of May is recognized by the Oklahoma State
4 Legislature as Asian/Pacific American Heritage Month.

5 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature recognizes the contributions of
6 Asian Americans and Pacific Islanders to the history of Oklahoma and
7 the United States.

8
9 DIRECT TO CALENDAR.